

where multimedia is used. Who can forget the high profile animation techniques used in *Jurassic Park* and high-end morphing techniques used in *Terminator* and *The Matrix*? Multimedia is also widely used in Virtual Reality, wherein complex mechanisms are represented in virtual 3D environments that seem almost lifelike. Multimedia and Virtual Reality are widely used in virtual design and visualisation, and sensory management applications. It is also used for training pilots through in-flight simulation techniques and to guide medical students through complex surgical operations. Architects and building designers make use of CAD/CAM and virtual walkthroughs in their presentations, all of which uses multimedia applications.

The education sector is another area where multimedia is used for developing interactive games, CD-ROMs and multimedia titles that provide you with fascinating information—how a pupa metamorphoses to a butterfly captured in all its glory—in the most interactive fashion.

The greener grass

Though the recent slump in the US market has put the software industry in a tight spot, professionals in the multimedia industry report a growth. “It is in fact boom time as the European markets are opening up and there is a good enough demand for multimedia professionals,

both designers and developers,” says Rajiv Sangari, deputy general manager, Pentamedia Graphics.

As such, Indian talent is a major force to reckon with and people with the required knowledge can now diversify their talent to suit future requirements. “It need not be a US-based market. Major countries in the West (in Europe) are welcoming Indian talent and it is for us to tap this opportunity,” adds Sangari.

“India is on the verge of an animation boom and the need for multimedia professionals is being felt like never before. Industry estimates say that the global digital animation industry is estimated to grow to a whopping \$70 billion by 2005 from the current \$25 billion,” says Sumathi Sridharan, vice president-production, Pentamedia Graphics Limited. The multimedia industry is booming and it is up to the people to make use of the opportunity. Software programmers who are contemplating a career shift and are well versed in C and C++, need only sharpen their skills to suit the changing environment. The time and effort put forth by an individual in learning these languages can definitely be useful if efforts are channeled in the right direction. ■

Disclaimer: Digit does not vouch for the quality of courses and training offered at any of the institutes mentioned here. Before registering with any of the institutes, it is better to check the credentials of the institute and aspects such as the training methodology and placement assistance, amongst others.

Animating Media

What makes interactive multimedia so fascinating is the animation and cool effects that make the whole package alive. Basically computer animation is the process of creating moving sequences of images (such as cartoons and animated films).

There are usually four steps involved in creating an animation sequence: First, a storyboard is created to provide a visual script for the animation sequence. The next step is modelling, where the objects to be animated are created using software such as 3D Studio Max. The next step is scripting/movement control, where static images are manipulated. Finally, the animation is rendered, that is, the sequence is put together in its final form.

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